[METRIC]

A-A-2642
February 1, 1993

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

BINDER, LOOSE-LEAF, PLASTIC BOUND, STIFF COVERS (FOR TABULATING MACHINE PAPER AND ACCESSORIES).

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in lieu of Type I, Grade A of Federal Specification UU-B-336D, which is cancelled.

This commercial item description covers requirements for flexible-post binders for containing unburst marginal punched tabulating machine paper and accessories. Covers are separable and have a binding mechanism with locking devices for containment of contents.

Classification: The binders shall be of the following classes and styles, as specified (see 6.b).

Class 1 - Top and bottom loading
Class 2 - Top loading.

Style A - Inside locking mechanism.
Style B - Outside locking mechanism.

1. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS:

A. Design. Binders shall be designed for containing continuous, unburst, marginal punched tabulating sheets by means of flexible posts secured by a locking device in the binding mechanism. Binders, and sheets filed in all binders, shall lay flat so there will be no hidden entries when in use. Binders shall be designed for satisfactory performance, including loading and unloading of binders and for proper retention and performance of posts. Sheet size, capacity and color of the binder shall be as specified (see 6.b). The first dimension cited for the sheet size shall be the binding side. Not less than two flexible posts shall be furnished with each binder, and shall be of sufficient length to meet the capacity requirements specified.

Class 1. Class 1 binders shall be designed for loading or withdrawal of sheets from the top and bottom of the binder.

Class 2. Class 2 binders shall be designed for loading or withdrawal of the sheets from the top of the binder only.

Style A. Style A binders shall be designed so that the cover stubs turn into the binder and have an inside locking mechanism.

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A: Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:24Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Style B. Style B binder shall be of a mechanical hinge, piano style, with an outside locking mechanism in the top hinge plate, and be designed for loading from top only.

B. Construction (general). Each binder shall consist of two separable covers, hinged to cover stubs or plates, as applicable, for containment of a binding mechanism. Construction shall be such that no parts of the binders will mar smooth surfaces. Metal hinge components shall be properly secured and aligned. Hinges shall be recessed into plates in accordance with normal commercial practice, and plates and covers shall lay flat on smooth, even surfaces. Covers shall have round corners on the side of the binder, parallel to the binding side.

Covers. Covers shall be paperboard, as specified in 1.C.(3). The binding material shall be plastic, as specified in 1.C.(1), and shall completely cover the inner and outer surfaces of the board, extending beyond the covers to fabricate the hinges and stubs.

Hinges. Hinges shall consist of at least two layers of plastics which extend from the covers and shall be reinforced over the entire area of hinge with vinyl-impregnated nylon cloth, or by other means which will provide equivalent reinforcing strength and flexibility to that of the specified cloth. A strip of black fiberboard, or equivalent material, 1.14 ± 0.0762 mm (0.045 ± 0.003)" in thickness and the approximate width of the binding mechanism, shall be bound into each cover stub for reinforcement and mounting of the binding mechanism. All edges of the binding material shall be heat sealed.

Binding Mechanism. Post holes shall be provided in both top and bottom covers to receive and securely retain flexible posts. All binders shall have two post holes spaced on proper centers to utilize sprockets feed holes of the sheet size specified. Requirements for additional post holes (multiple spacing) shall be as specified (see 6.e).

(a). Class 1, Style A. The binding mechanisms shall consist of two channel bars fabricated from cold-rolled steel 0.46 ± 0.05 mm (0.018 ± 0.002)" in thickness. One channel bar shall be attached to each cover stub by at least three metal rivets or grommets. One rivet or grommet shall be positioned in the center and one near each end of the binding mechanism. The rivets or grommets shall have sufficient upset to permanently secure the channel bars to the cover stub. Each channel bar shall have post holes in the number and with center spacing specified, and shall be fitted with two slide locks to secure the flexible posts. Stops for slide locks shall be provided in each channel bar. The slide locks shall be made of steel or plastic material. Plastic slide locks shall conform to 1-2-1 of ASTM D 1788. Slide locks shall be of sufficient thickness and design to withstand repeated opening and

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T08:24Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

closing. When covers are attached to the binding mechanism, post holes shall be in alignment.

(b). Class 2, Style A. The binding mechanism shall be as specified in (a) above except that the bottom channel bar shall be without slide locks and shall have post holes to accept the flexible posts. Alternately, at the option of the manufacturer, a steel bar or bar with post holes to accept the flexible posts may be furnished in place of the bottom channel bar, provided it is equal or greater in thickness to the channel bar specified above.

Posts. Posts for Class 1 binders (top and bottom loading) shall be nylon or wire fully encased in plastic, at the option of the manufacturer (see below). Nylon posts for the Class 1 binder shall have both ends tapered. Nylon posts for the Class 2 binder (top loading) shall be nylon with one end tapered and a slotted head on the opposite end. The diameter of the head shall be larger than that of the post in accordance with good commercial practice. When heads of the posts are recessed in the binder, slot shall be designed and construed in a manner to permit tightening or removal of posts. Tightening or removal of posts shall be interpreted to mean by means of a small screwdriver or other applicable device. Posts shall be flexible and sufficiently stable so as not to loosen in the binding mechanism nor break or take a permanent set when compressed by the locking device(s). Replacement posts shall be furnished, as specified (see 6.e).

Nylon posts. Nylon posts shall be 3.18 ± 0.10 mm (0.125 ± 0.004)" in diameter, and shall conform to ASTM D 789.

Wire posts. The posts shall consist of at least seven strands of No. 22 annealed, galvanized wire encased in plastic in accordance with normal commercial practice. The plastic shall completely encase the wire, including the ends. The posts shall be not less than 2.84 mm (0.112") nor more than 3.30 mm (0.130") in outside diameter.

Suspension (Hanger) Bars. Suspension (hanger) bars shall be designed for use with binders racks or cabinets. Bars shall be compatible for use with the binder rack or cabinet specified (see 6.d).

Label Holder and Label. When specified, a label holder and label shall be provided in accordance with normal commercial practice, except that label holders shall not be of the cellulose nitrate type. Label holders shall be of the size and location on the binder as specified (see 6.f). Unless otherwise specified, the label holder shall be built into, or otherwise, securely attached to the binder and shall be nonremovable. The label holder shall be constructed so that the label can be readily inserted, removed and in the manner that the label will be retained and not fall out when

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:24Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

binder is in normal use. Binders furnished with label holders shall be designed and fabricated in a manner that the holders will not weaken the structure of the binder nor mar smooth surfaces.

Identification Marking. The manufacturer's name or trademark of such known character as to be readily identifiable, shall be permanently marked by any acceptable commercial method on the inside of one cover of the binder. When specified, the words "Property of U.S. Government" shall be included in the marking.

C. Materials.

(1). Binding material. The binding material shall be made of vinyl meeting the physical requirements specified in Table I below:

Table I. Binding (vinyl) material

Characteristic	Requirement	Test Method
Thickness	0.36 ± 0.05 mm (0.014 ± 0.005 inch)	Any Commercial
Tensile strength at yield each direction, minimum	15000 kPa (2200 psi)	ASTM D 638
Tear resistance, each direction, minimum	105 Newtons/100 mm (6.0 lb_f/inch)	ASTM D 1004
Cold Crack at -17.8 ± 2 °C (-0 ± 2) °F Temperature	No evidence of cracking	Fed.Std.191 Method 5874

(2). Metal components. Metal Surfaces shall be in accordance with good commercial quality for the purpose intended. Exposed metal surfaces shall have a polished finish and shall be corrosion resistant or treated to resist corrosion, except binding mechanisms for Style B binders may be painted. Unless otherwise specified, cold-rolled steel shall have a minimum Rockwell hardness of B40, when tested in accordance with ASTM E 18.

(3). Paperboard. The paperboard shall have a minimum thickness of 3.0 mm (0.120") when tested in accordance with TAPPI T 411, and shall have a minimum bursting strength of 700 points when tested in accordance with TAPPI T 807.

D. Workmanship. The binders shall be well finished, clean and all edges shall be smooth. Metal parts of the binders shall be free from burrs and rough or sharp edges. Posts shall be designed and constructed for easy and ready flexing and passage through eyelets and contents of the binder without binding, fraying, spreading, or

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T08:24Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

otherwise being deformed. There shall be no unfinished edges around the label holder and the construction shall be such that the binding material will not tear, fray or pull out under normal use. The paperboard shall be free from surface lumps, indentation and mechanical imperfections, and be reasonably smooth and flat. The binder shall be free from defects that adversely affect appearance and serviceability or present a hazard to the user.

2. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISION.

A. Responsibility for Inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this Commercial Item Description, where such inspection are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

B. Sampling. Samples shall be selected for inspection in accordance with MIL-STD-105 using the plans described in Table II. A lot shall consist of a number of items manufactured by the same process from the same components at the same time. Random samples shall be drawn from each lot for the end item inspection. Unless otherwise specified, every lot shall be tested.

Table II

Inspection	Inspection Level	AQL (%)	Sample Unit	Requirements Paragraph/s
Design & Construction	S-2	4.0	1 Binder	1.A & 1.B
Materials	I	4.0	*	1.C
Workmanship	I	4.0	1 Binder	1.D
Packaging, Packing & Marking	S-4	4.0	1 Shipping container	4

* Certificates of compliance are acceptable for the component testing. If certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check the validity of such certification.

3. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS: the contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, to the maximum extent practicable.

4. PACKAGING, PACKING AND MARKING: Packing, packing and marking shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T08:24Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5. REFERENCED DOCUMENTS:

A. Public Law:

Public Law 94-580 - Resource Conservation and Recovery Act (Part of U.S. Code, Title 42)

Copies of the U.S. Code may be obtained through the Congressional Sales Office, U.S Government Printing Office, Washington D.C. 20402.

B. Federal Specifications and Standards:

Fed.Std.191/5874 - Temperature, Low, Effect on Coated Cloth.

Single copies of Federal Specification and Standards required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston, MA; New York, NY; Washington, DC: Atlanta, GA; Chicago, IL; Kansas City, MO; Fort Worth, TX; Denver, CO; San Francisco, CA; Los Angeles, CA; and Auburn, WA.

In addition to the Business Service Centers, Federal Standards, Specification and Commercial Item Descriptions, may be obtained from GSA Specification Unit (3FPB-W), 7th and D Streets S.W., Washington, DC 20407. Their current phone numbers, should anyone ask, are (202) 708-9205, or FTS-458-9205.

C. Military Standard:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

MIL-STD-105 is available from Naval Publication and Forms Center; 5801 Tabor Avenue; and Materials; Philadelphia, PA 19120.

D. American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM):

ASTM D 638 - Standard Test Method for Tensile Properties of Plastics.
ASTM D 789 - Nylon Injection Molding and Extrusion Materials.
ASTM D 1004 - Standard Test Method for initial Tear Resistance of Plastic film and Sheeting.
ASTM D 1788 - Standard Specification for Rigid Acrylonitrile-Butadiene-Styrene (ABS) Plastics.
ASTM E 18 - Rockwell Hardness and Rockwell Superficial Hardness of Metallic Materials.

ASTM standards test method can be obtained from the American Society for Testing and Material; 1916 Race Street; Philadelphia, PA 191103.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:24Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

E. Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI):

T 410 - Weight Per Unit Area (Basis Weight or Substance) of Paper and Paperboard.
T 411 - Thickness (Caliper) of Paper and Paperboard and liningboard.
T 807 - Bursting Strength of Paperboard and Linerboard.

TAPPI standard T test methods can be obtained from Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry; Technology Park/Atlanta; P.O. Box 105113; Atlanta, Ga 30348.

6. ORDERING DATA. Purchasers shall specify the following in the contract or purchase order:

a). Title, number, and date of this Commercial Item Description.
b). Class, style, sheet size, capacity and color of the binder.
c). Specify when paperboard requirements (for cover construction) are other than that specified.
d). Accessories required. Suspension (hanger bars). When suspension bars are required, include manufacturer and model of rack or cabinet within which binders will be used.
e). Replacement posts, (if required). Post hole spacing required.
f). Labels, label holders, label holder's size and location.
g). Packaging, Packing and Marking required. Any special marking.

7. Item Identification/Reference Part Number System (for cataloging use only)

A-A-2642 2 A This example describes a plastic bound binder with the inside locking mechanism, designed for loading or withdrawal of sheets from the top.

A-Style A: Inside locking mechanism
B-Style B Outside locking mechanism

1-Class 1: Top and bottom loading
2-Class 2: Top loading

MILITARY INTEREST:

ARMY - GL

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA - FSS

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-26T08:24Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.